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DJIA 49407.66 ▲ 515.19 1.05% NASDAQ 23592.11 ▲ 0.6% STOXX 600 617.31 ▲ 1.0% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 9/32, yield 4.276% OIL \$62.14 ▼ \$3.07 GOLD \$4,622.50 ▼ \$91.40 EURO \$1.1791 YEN 155.61

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Elon Musk said SpaceX** has acquired xAI, a deal that combines his powerful rocket-and-satellite business with his artificial-intelligence startup that is facing steep competition. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq advancing 0.5%, 1.1% and 0.6%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **The January jobs report** won't be released as scheduled Friday because of a partial government shutdown, the Bureau of Labor Statistics said. **A2**
- ◆ **A massive downturn** in cryptocurrencies reignited worry about the risks of stockpiling bitcoin and other digital assets, potentially forcing some companies to unload their holdings and deepen the selloff. **A1**
- ◆ **Palantir reported** another quarter of record revenue, reflecting strong demand for its AI technology from the U.S. government and commercial businesses. **B1**
- ◆ **Devon Energy agreed** to buy Coterra Energy in a roughly \$21.5 billion all-stock deal that would create one of the largest U.S. oil-and-gas producers. **B1**
- ◆ **Vanguard said it would** cut fees on a quarter of its U.S. funds, bringing the group's average expense ratio across all funds to 0.06%. **B1**
- ◆ **Cboe is in discussions** with retail brokerages to relaunch "all-or-nothing" options contracts for individual investors that would vie with prediction markets. **B11**
- ◆ **Oracle said it plans** to raise between \$45 billion and \$50 billion this year to fund its AI infrastructure build-out. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **A U.S. intelligence official** alleged wrongdoing by Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard in a whistleblower complaint that is so highly classified it has sparked months of wrangling over how to share it with Congress. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump demanded** that House lawmakers back the bipartisan spending deal passed by the Senate and set aside policy demands in an effort to quickly end a partial government shutdown. **A4**
- ◆ **The U.S. agreed** to reduce tariffs to 18% on India, which in turn will stop buying Russian oil, Trump said. **A2**
- ◆ **Dozens of people** have died and thousands are without power nearly a week after a winter storm pummeled much of the U.S. **A3**
- ◆ **U.S. and Iranian officials** are poised to meet in Turkey this week amid efforts by regional powers to find a diplomatic alternative to a clash that risks sparking broader turmoil. **A6**
- ◆ **Britain's prime minister** ordered an urgent investigation into a former U.K. envoy to the U.S. after emails provided fresh details about the relationship between Epstein and the ex-ambassador. **A7**
- ◆ **Bill and Hillary Clinton** made a new offer to give depositions for a House panel's investigation of Epstein. **A4**
- ◆ **Top Justice Department officials** narrowed the role of a lawyer who had been tasked with pursuing matters of interest to Trump and his allies. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is preparing to develop a stockpile of critical minerals. **A4**

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Handful of Gazans Enter Egypt as Border Opens



SLOW START: A Palestinian child waves from a bus evacuating patients and relatives from the Gaza Strip after the Rafah border crossing to Egypt reopened Monday. Only a few passed through the crossing after security screenings caused delays. **A6**

Wild Betting Markets Propel Polymarket's 'Truth Machine'

Justice Department probe gets shelved, but controversy still follows the platform

By ALEXANDER OSIPOVICH
AND CAITLIN OSTROFF

Just before dawn on Nov. 13, 2024, FBI agents smashed through the door of Shayne Coplan's penthouse apartment in Manhattan, barged into his bedroom and grabbed his phone. Federal prosecutors were investigating whether the cryptocurrency-based betting platform he founded, Polymarket,

where users can wager on everything from presidential elections to the identity of the next James Bond actor, was violating laws designed to prevent money laundering. Fourteen months later, the fortunes of the shaggy-haired 27-year-old couldn't be more different. The Justice Department has dropped its probe. Donald Trump Jr., whose venture-capital firm is an investor, joined the company as an adviser. The New York Stock Exchange's parent company struck an investment deal that boosted Polymarket's value to \$9 billion and made Coplan a billionaire. And his startup,

which had long been off-limits to U.S. users, was cleared to launch a betting app for them. The predictions derived from Polymarket's betting action—Coplan has called the operation a "global truth machine"—are now cropping up everywhere. Analysts and national news outlets cite them regularly. Google, X, the National Hockey League and Dow Jones, the publisher of The Wall Street Journal, have all struck data partnerships with Polymarket. Yet for all its mainstream success, Polymarket hasn't managed to stamp out controversy tied to its free-wheeling markets, most of which remain

unregulated. In the past few months alone, there have been flaps over the possible manipulation of bets tied to the Russia-Ukraine war, traders seeming to have advance knowledge about whether bets are being resolved fairly. Polymarket's popular international platform still doesn't require identity checks for most users, making it largely anonymous. And researchers have cast doubt on whether its billions of dollars in reported trading volume are

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Rural Towns Try To Hold Back Heavy Tide of AI

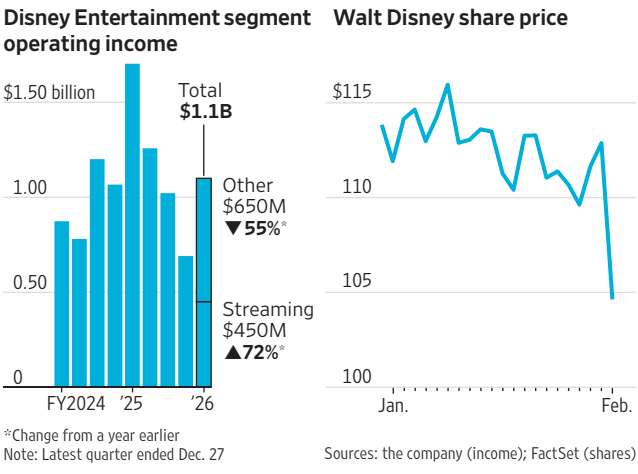
By ANVEE BHUTANI
AND AMRITH RAMKUMAR

Howell Township, a conservative farming area in Michigan, is known for being friendly to businesses. But when a developer proposed converting 1,000 acres of farmland into a massive data center for training artificial-intelligence models last year, the community fought back. The town's planning commission and the county's planning commission eventually voted not to advance the project, a potential \$1 billion site for Facebook parent Meta Platforms, and the developer recently withdrew its request after Howell Township put a moratorium on new data-center development. "I assumed Republicans would be for this: business, deregulation," said Breanne Green, a community organizer who helped start one of the first Facebook groups there opposing the project. "That just evaporated." The battle is part of a nationwide resistance to the AI boom, challenging President Trump and others who have embraced the technology. Fearing rising utility costs, job losses and privacy violations, locals blocked or delayed about 20 projects around the country representing nearly \$100 billion in combined investment in the second quarter of last year, according to

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Slow Growth Hits Disney

Disney shares fell 7.4% Monday after executives said growth in the current quarter would be hurt by higher costs for sports rights as well as theme-park and cruise-line expansions. **B1**



Mamdani's Toughest Transition: Moving a Cat Into Gracie Mansion

Mayor gets allergy shots so he and his wife can get a pet without a 'Hitch'

By JAMES FANELLI

Zohran Mamdani bared his arm in an act of love. Then an allergist jabbed him with a needle. The new mayor of New York City is preparing for what could be his prickliest transition: Mamdani is allergic to cats, but his wife, Rama Duwaji, wants one for Gracie Mansion, the couple's now official residence on Manhattan's Upper East Side. He started taking weekly shots in December to build up a tolerance to felines. Without the seven-month regimen, having a cat around wouldn't be pretty for the 34-year-old. If he spends an hour with a cat, he starts looking like Will Smith in "Hitch," he

said. In the movie, Smith has an allergic reaction to food, causing his face and ears to puff and an eye to swell shut. That would prove inconvenient for someone whose job requires him to be on camera nearly as much as a Kardashian. The Democratic socialist rose from relative obscurity last year to become the city's mayor thanks to his social-media savviness and message of affordability. Supporters and critics alike are closely watching to see if Mamdani makes good on his bold promises. This one has generally been met with a warm reception since the mayoral couple let the cat out of the bag. (A plan to install bidets was

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Strategy to Hoard Crypto Stings Fans

By VICKY GE HUANG

A massive downturn in cryptocurrencies has reignited worry about the risks of stockpiling bitcoin and other digital assets, potentially forcing some companies to unload their holdings and deepen the sell-off. Bitcoin, ether and other digital tokens are in a slump, and the shares of companies that followed Michael Saylor's company, now known as Strategy, in stockpiling crypto are sliding, too. The selloff has inves-

tors on edge, and on the lookout for signs it will force big firms to dump their holdings—triggering further declines in digital-coin prices. The risks of reorienting a corporate strategy around relatively new, and notoriously volatile, assets like cryptocurrencies were always present. But bitcoin and other popular tokens kept climbing last year, fueled in part by signs from Washington that the Trump administration would clear the regulatory hurdles necessary

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Gabbard Complaint Stalls in Her Agency

By DUSTIN VOLZ
AND C. RYAN BARBER

WASHINGTON—A U.S. intelligence official has alleged wrongdoing by Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard in a whistleblower complaint that is so highly classified it has sparked months of wrangling over how to share it with Congress, according to U.S. officials and others familiar with the matter. The filing of the complaint has prompted a continuing, behind-the-scenes struggle about how to assess and handle it, with the whistleblower's lawyer accusing Gabbard of stonewalling the complaint. Gabbard's office rejects that characterization, contending it is navigating a unique set of circumstances and working to resolve the issue. A cloak-and-dagger mystery

reminiscent of a John le Carré novel is swirling around the complaint, which is said to be locked in a safe. Disclosure of its contents could cause "grave damage to national security," one official said. It also implicates another federal agency beyond Gabbard's, and raises potential claims of executive privilege that might involve the White House, officials said. The complaint was filed last May with the intelligence community's inspector general, according to a November letter that the whistleblower's lawyer addressed to Gabbard. The letter, which was reviewed by The Wall Street Journal, accused Gabbard's office of hindering the dissemination of the complaint to lawmakers by failing to provide necessary security guid-

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